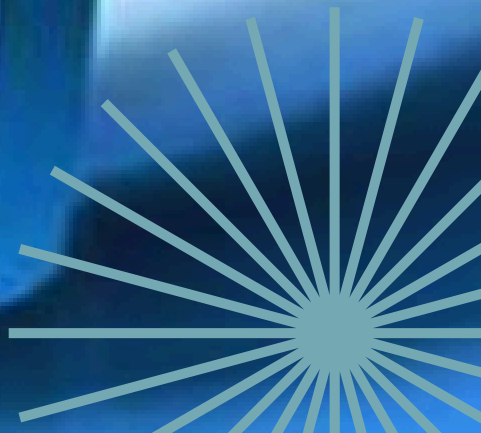
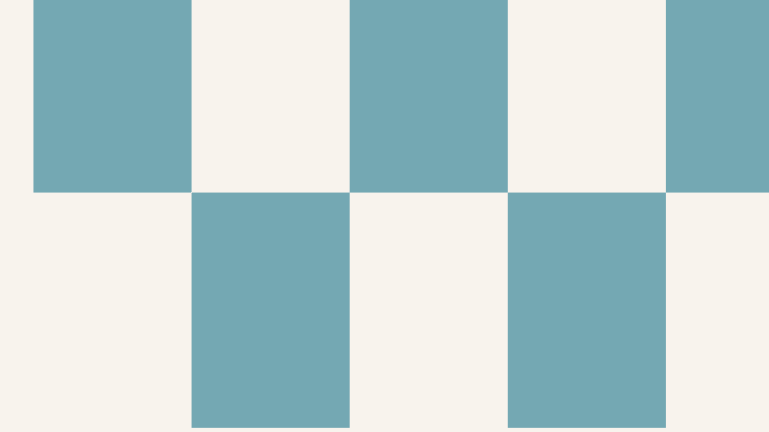


CHAPTER 10

TECHNOLOGY FOR MICE INDUSTRY



LEARNING OUTCOMES



At the end of the chapter, you should be able to:

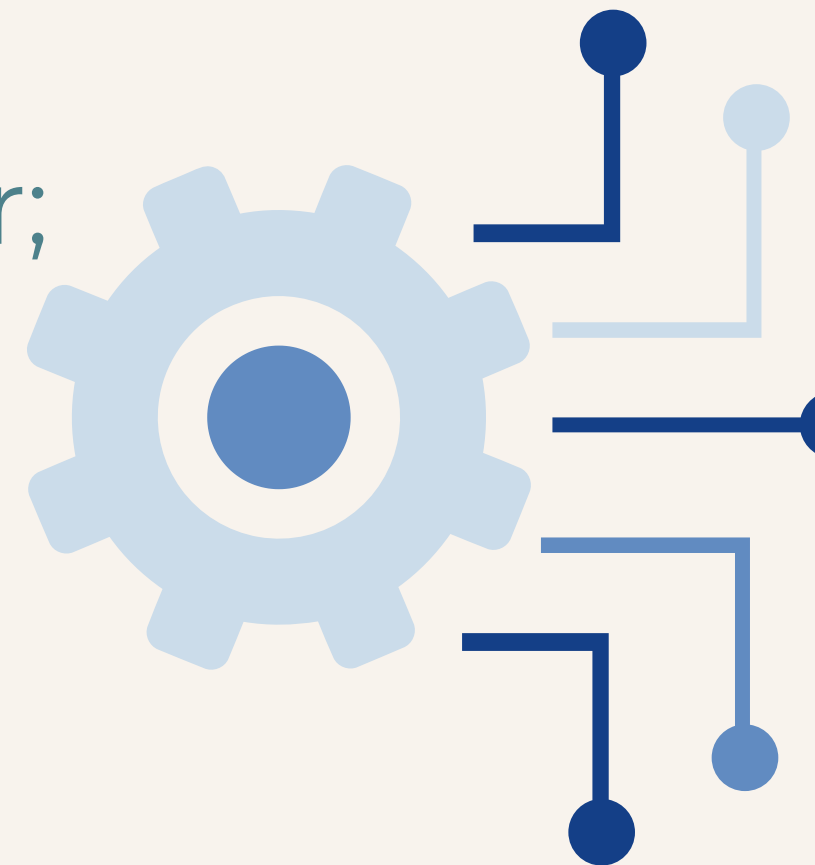
1. determine the role and scope of technology in the MICE industry;
2. explain the advantages of technology over manual systems;
3. discuss the data processing systems;
4. describe the types of hardware configuration;
5. explain the significance of the Internet; and
6. discuss the technology trends.



THE ROLE AND SCOPE OF TECHNOLOGY IN THE MICE INDUSTRY

The major role of technology in the MICE industry is to gather, store, and provide data to the different levels of users. The significant advantages of technology over manual systems are:

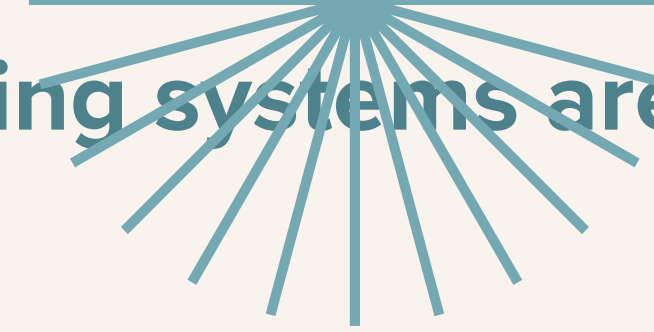
1. opportunities to use data in a more effective and appropriate way;
2. greater dependability; less possibility of human error;
3. harmonious operations;
4. safer data; and
5. real-time analysis and review.



At present, most MICE organizations maintain a paperless office, where the company depends completely on software collection, storage, and retrieval of data. There are many types of computer technology that are currently used. These systems can be identified by the method they use to process information, by the type of filing system used for storing and retrieving data and by hardware configuration.



Data Processing Systems Data processing systems are divided into three types:

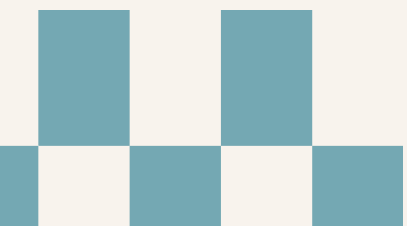


1. Batch processing
2. Online real-time processing
3. Time-sharing and service bureaus

Batch data processing systems collect event negotiations, such as all income and invoices for a day, and prepare them as a group. For example, all sales in one day are treated as a “one-day sale” and recorded in the computer system as a single batch. This method is simple, reliable, and cheaper because it does not require immediate network backup or full employee training. However, it does not allow instant negotiations, so MICE managers cannot get up-to-date information. For this reason, batch processing is rarely used by large MICE companies but is still applied by small and medium-sized ones.

Real-time data processing

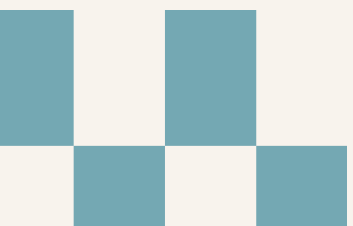
Real-time data processing records transactions immediately as they happen, so accounts like sales income, admission income, and inventory are always updated. Data from different **MICE** units can be integrated into the main office's system, which may use real-time or batch processing. Managers connect to the central system in different ways—some may have full access to all data, while others may have limited access. This setup allows MICE managers to effectively organize activities, monitor goods, track income, and compare information. However, real-time systems are more expensive than batch processing because they require continuous updates and advanced systems. They are mostly used by medium and large MICE companies.



Hardware Configuration

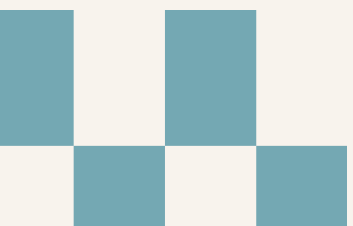
Many types of hardware configuration are common, in the MICE industry. These are:

1. online systems;
2. PC systems; and
3. distributed data processing.



ONLINE SYSTEMS

Online systems allow each transaction to be entered through a communication device connected to a computer, such as using magnetic cards. They may or may not operate in real-time, depending on how quickly transactions are processed and updated. Many large MICE companies use **Electronic Data Interchange (EDI)**, which is the computer-to-computer exchange of business documents in a standard format. This system converts documents like purchase orders, invoices, attendance reports, and checks into a form that employees can easily read and process.

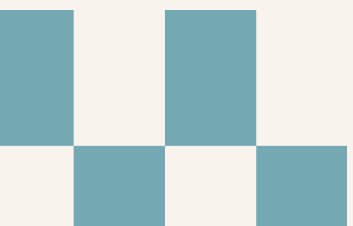


EDI can be applied in two ways:

Direct Method – connects the **MICE** company's computer system directly with a major client or supplier (e.g., a beverage supplier). For example, when attendance numbers change, the supplier is automatically updated to avoid shortages.

Indirect Method – uses a network or “**mailbox**” system where messages are converted into the receiver's preferred format. This allows one sender to reach multiple receivers without changing formats. For example, when a MICE company submits event details, suppliers can check the mailbox and submit their offers accordingly.

This makes online systems efficient in improving communication, avoiding shortages, and streamlining operations.



Event Management
Organization



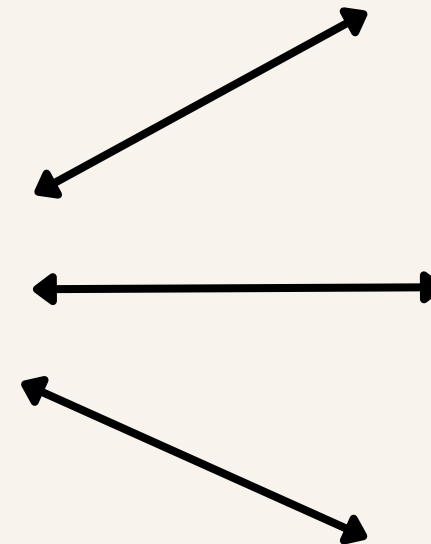
Beverage Supplier

Figure 10.1

Event Management
Organization



Mailbox



Beverage Supplier

Food Supplier

Transportation
Company

Figure 10.2

DISTRIBUTED DATA PROCESSING

Distributed data processing, each branch of a MICE company uses computers (**PCs**) to handle its own transactions and then sends the data to the main office. The main office usually has a bigger computer (mainframe) to collect everything. These computers are connected through networks like **LAN (for nearby areas)** or **WAN (for wider areas)**. This setup allows managers to share information, communicate easily, and divide the work.

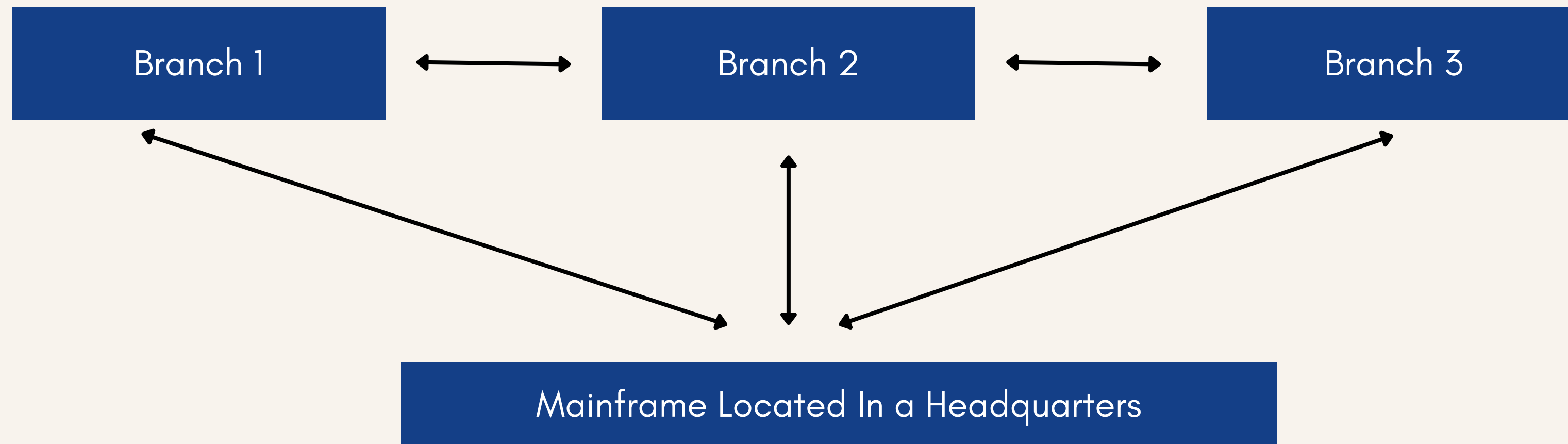
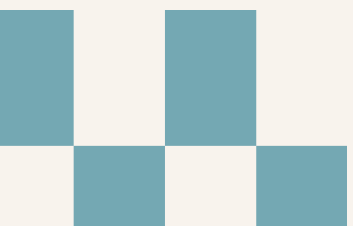


Figure 10.3

Access Control

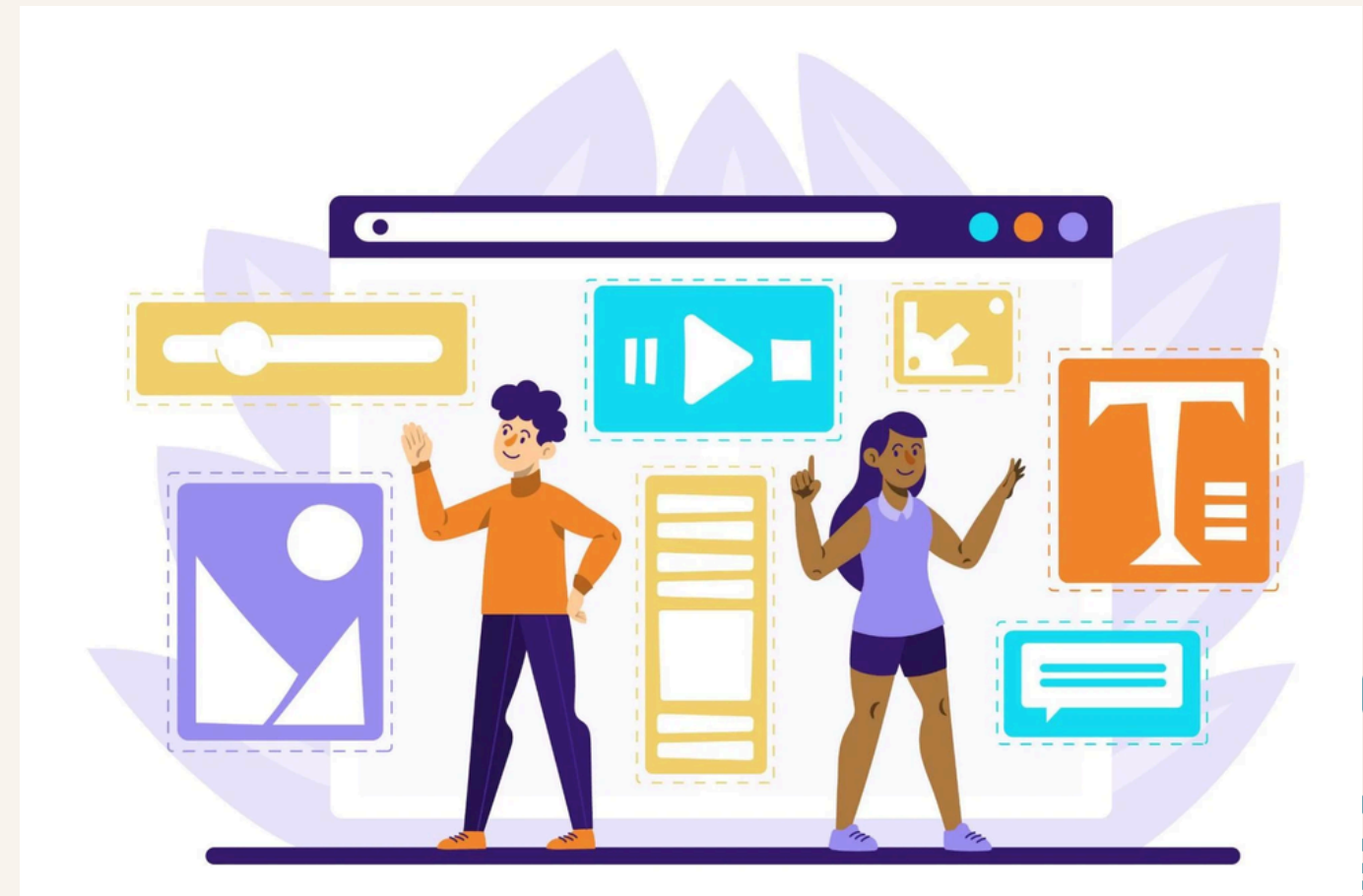
Access control ensures that only authorized people can use or change files and data. In online systems and **EDI**, this is managed through passwords. Some passwords allow only viewing data, while others allow editing. At least two people should have master access so company operations continue even if one is unavailable.



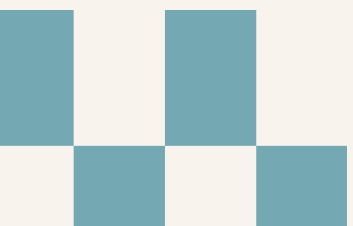
Interactive Web

The internet, once limited to schools and the military, became an important business tool. **MICE** companies use websites to share information, promote services, and attract customers. To reach more people, they register their sites with search engines like Google or Yahoo!, so potential clients can find them using keywords such as “event” or “event management. The more general the keywords, the more potential matches will be produced by a search program. **The following are the advantages that a site can provide to a MICE company:**

1. Wide market reach
2. Ability to update information quickly and easily
3. Ability to gather data about potential customers
4. Ability to decrease marketing expenses

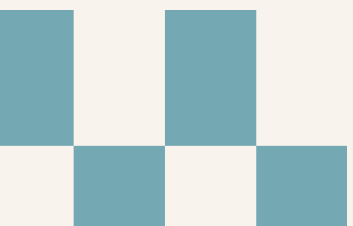


Websites help small and medium-sized MICE companies compete with big ones by reaching many potential clients. They also let companies gather information from visitors, like email, interests, and location. This data can be used to create a customer list and offer more personalized services.



Mice Industry Database

The **MICE industry** is growing fast, but printed catalogs quickly become outdated. Online databases solve this problem because they can be updated anytime and are more reliable. A good database depends on having many resources and easy search features, like searching by region, service, or price. With the internet, MICE companies can use online and interactive databases that allow quick updates, easy access, and customizable searches using keywords.



Trends In Technology

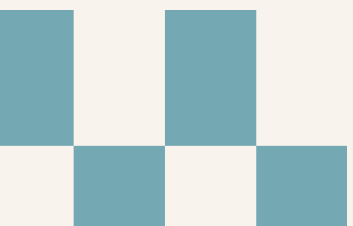
For the past 20 years, small and medium-sized MICE companies rarely used technology, but today almost all have computers, internet, and email. In the future, software will become more customized, user-friendly, and affordable due to greater competition. A major innovation is the **Wireless Application Protocol (WAP)**, developed by companies like Nokia and Ericsson, which allows internet services to be accessed through mobile phones.

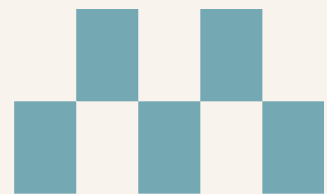
Since over 90% of MICE professionals use cell phones, **WAP** makes communication faster, cheaper, and more profitable. Technology now allows MICE companies to manage events online, even in other countries, without moving staff. However, systems must be designed so all participants, even with slow internet, can access the same services.



Summary

The main role of technology in the MICE industry is to gather, store, and provide data for different users. Compared to manual systems, it offers more efficiency, reliability, fewer errors, smoother operations, safer data, and real-time analysis. Today, most MICE companies use paperless offices that rely on software for data collection, storage, and retrieval. Different technologies are used, which can be identified by how they process information, their filing systems, and their hardware setup.





THANK YOU

